

Whidbey Island Horse Council

5-4-26 Meeting Summary

The Whidbey Island Horse Council was called to order on May 4, 2026 by coordinator Leslie Thurston (Sally Garratt was absent). The meeting was recorded and an AI summary of the meeting was created instead of meeting minutes. That summary is attached below. A complete AI summary of the meeting will be posted on the HC webpage. The next meeting of the Horse Council was scheduled for June 3, 2026 at the 6:30 at the Race Road Fire Station.

The Whidbey Island Horse Council meeting focused on website development, social media presence, and emergency response planning for equine incidents. The group discussed progress with Vicki Moser on website development and reviewed Facebook group administration requirements, including membership screening questions to ensure participants are genuinely connected to the local horse community. A significant portion of the meeting addressed equine emergency response protocols, where Donna Debonis DVM presented information about existing fire department capabilities and animal control procedures. The discussion revealed that local fire departments, particularly North Whidbey Fire and Navy Search and Rescue, are well-equipped and trained for horse rescue situations, though equipment storage and training opportunities remain topics for further exploration. The group also addressed the need for educational resources about proper emergency response procedures and discussed potential collaboration with Amber Palmer for first aid and emergency training classes.